

Teacher Guide — French Revolution

History | Grade 9-10

Period 1

Entry Ticket

On a short slip, answer in one sentence: Why did people attack the Bastille on 14 July 1789? Pick the main reason you think and add one phrase of evidence (a fact or a feeling) that supports your choice.

Expected response: Students will give one of: (a) To free many political prisoners — evidence: "it was a prison"; (b) To get weapons — evidence: "there were arms stored"; (c) To protest the king and taxes — evidence: "people were angry"; (d) To make a symbolic stand — evidence: "it stood for royal power." Teacher will use answers to spot the common misconception that many prisoners were rescued. The correct factual point to surface: the chapter reports the Bastille held only seven prisoners; its fall mattered more as a symbol.

Teacher Script

0-5 min: Collect entry slips and quick whole-class share

Collect the slips. Say: "Two quick counts: how many answers said 'to free many prisoners'? Hold up a hand. How many said 'to get weapons'? How many said 'to protest the king/taxes'? How many said 'symbolic stand'?" After counting, say: "Keep your slip — we'll return to it at the end. We started with a factual belief about the Bastille. Today we will check facts from the chapter and see how facts and symbols worked together in 1789."

Board: Write: "Entry ticket: Why attack the Bastille?" and tally the four categories as the hands are counted.

- Anticipate: Student: "Do we have to hand these in?" — Yes, keep them; I'll read some aloud later.
- Anticipate: Student: "What if my answer is more than one reason?" — That's fine; tell me the main reason you gave.

5-15 min: Introduce causes and key definitions

Say exactly: "I will read two short definitions from the chapter. First: 'Estates-General: A representative body of the three estates (clergy, nobility, Third Estate) last convened in 1614 and called in 1789 to address the fiscal crisis.' Second: 'National Assembly: The body declared by the Third Estate in June 1789 claiming to represent the nation and undertaking to draft a constitution.'" Then say: "Now list aloud with me the causes named in the chapter. I will say a cause and you repeat it: social crisis; economic crisis; financial crisis; political crisis; resistance to reform; indecisive royal policy." After students repeat, say: "These factors combined; the chapter is clear that there was not one single cause. Note the chapter presents competing interpretations: some historians stress ideas, others stress immediate crises. We'll use both types of evidence today."

Board: Write the two definitions exactly as read. Below them write bullet causes: social, economic, financial, political, resistance to reform, indecisive royal policy.

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Anticipate: Student: "What does 'fiscal' mean?" — Explain briefly: fiscal means 'about money and government revenue and debt'.

- Anticipate: Student: "Which cause mattered most?" — Say: "The chapter gives no single answer; historians disagree. We'll look at evidence for several causes."

15-27 min: Role play: Estates-General to Tennis Court Oath timeline

Tell students: "Get into groups of three. Each person will be one estate: clergy, nobility, Third Estate. Use the timeline boxes I draw. First task (4 minutes): list what each estate wants when the Estates-General meets in May 1789 — quick phrases. Second task (4 minutes): the Third Estate group decide to 'verify members' and break away — act this out in one sentence: 'We, the Third Estate, now declare ourselves the National Assembly and will draft a constitution.' Third task (4 minutes): hold a short mock 'Tennis Court Oath' — one student stands and says: 'We will not disperse until a constitution is agreed.'" Walk around, prompt groups: "Who verified members? How did the Third Estate claim to represent the nation?" After 12 minutes, bring the class together and ask one group to perform their one-sentence declaration and one group's oath sentence exactly as said above.

Board: Draw a three-box sketch labeled Clergy | Nobility | Third Estate, arrow from Third Estate to 'National Assembly'. Draw a short timeline: May 1789 — Estates-General convened; June 1789 — Third Estate declares National Assembly; Tennis Court Oath — deputies pledge not to disperse until constitution agreed.

- Anticipate: Student: "What does 'verify members' mean?" — Explain: "The Third Estate checked who was really a deputy and who could vote; they wanted accurate representation."
- Anticipate: Student: "Were all Third Estate members rich or poor?" — Say: "The Third Estate included town lawyers, merchants, and commoners; it was mixed."
- Anticipate: Student (misconception): "Did they immediately become the government?" — Clarify: "They claimed to represent the nation and began drafting a constitution, but the transition was contested."

27-35 min: Source comparison and short debate on Bastille's meaning

Hand out a short source excerpt printed on the board or read aloud: 'The chapter records popular rumours that inflated the Bastille's role; it actually held only seven prisoners.' Say: "Read that aloud with me. Turn to a neighbor and in two minutes decide: Was the storming of the Bastille mainly a factual rescue, or mainly a symbolic act? Use one piece of evidence from today's board (number of prisoners, symbol of royal power, or public fear about arms/food)." After two minutes, run a 4-minute paired debate: one student gives a 30-second point, the neighbor replies 30 seconds, repeat. Then ask for one quick whole-class summary sentence from three volunteers.

Board: Add under the timeline: 'Storming of the Bastille — 14 July 1789: few prisoners (7) but powerful symbol of royal authority.'

- Anticipate: Student: "How do we know the count 'seven' is correct?" — Say: "The chapter reports that fact and notes contemporary records; historians check prison records and eyewitness reports."
- Anticipate: Student: "If it held only seven, why attack it?" — Prompt them to use symbolism, fear of arms, and political crisis as answers.
- Anticipate: Student: "Was the Bastille full of political prisoners?" — Counter misconception: "No — that is a common myth the chapter corrects."

35-40 min: Check understanding and consolidate (exit writing)

Ask students to take out a sentence: "Write one sentence that explains how at least two kinds of crisis (choose from social, economic, financial, political) combined to produce the situation that led to these events in 1789. Use a fact from today (Estates-General called in 1789, Third Estate declared National Assembly, Tennis Court Oath, Bastille 14 July 1789)." Collect the sentences as they leave or have them hold up for a quick scan. Finish: "Tomorrow we will see how these events led to the August Decrees and the Declaration of the Rights of Man."

Board: Write the exit prompt exactly: 'Write one sentence: How did two crises combine to produce the 1789 break? Use one fact from today's board.'

- Anticipate: Student: "Do we have to name two specific crises?" — Yes, name two (for example: financial and political).
- Anticipate: Student: "Can I use 'symbolic' as a fact?" — Yes, you may say the Bastille was a symbol and give the prisoner number as evidence.

Blackboard Notes

- Key definitions
- Causes named in the chapter
- Quick timeline: Estates-General -> National Assembly -> Tennis Court Oath -> Bastille
- Bastille fact and symbolism
- Exit prompt
- Estates-General: A representative body of the three estates (clergy, nobility, Third Estate) last convened in 1614 and called in 1789 to address the fiscal crisis.
- National Assembly: The body declared by the Third Estate in June 1789 claiming to represent the nation and undertaking to draft a constitution.
- Causes (combined): social crisis; economic crisis; financial crisis; political crisis; resistance to reform; indecisive royal policy.
- Timeline bullets: May 1789 — Estates-General convened. June 1789 — Third Estate declares National Assembly. Tennis Court Oath — deputies pledge not to disperse until a constitution agreed. 14 July 1789 — Storming of the Bastille.
- Bastille: actually held only seven prisoners; its fall became a powerful symbol of the Ancien Régime — symbolic importance can outweigh factual scale in political memory.
- Exit prompt: Write one sentence: How did two crises combine to produce the 1789 break? Use one fact from today's board.
- Diagram: Three-column sketch labeled: Clergy | Nobility | Third Estate. Arrow from Third Estate -> National Assembly.
- Diagram: Short horizontal timeline with the four labelled points: May 1789 (Estates-General), June 1789 (National Assembly), Tennis Court Oath, 14 July 1789 (Bastille).

Activities

Mini Debate: What Sparked the Revolution? (12 min, debate)

Materials: One textbook or chapter copy per student, One printed slip per pair with their assigned position and two evidence prompts (teacher prepares in 5 minutes), Timer or stopwatch, Whiteboard or chart paper and marker

- 1. Arrange students in pairs. Tell pairs they will hold a two-minute debate where one

partner argues that political and financial crises were the main cause of 1789, and the other argues that social and economic pressures were the main cause. Hand each pair a printed slip with their positions and two lines labelled 'Text evidence 1' and 'Text evidence 2'.

- 2. Give pairs 4 minutes to find two pieces of evidence in their textbook chapter (one sentence each) that support their assigned position. Circulate and quietly point to likely paragraph headings if a pair is stuck; do not give the answers. After 4 minutes announce time.
- 3. Start the debate rounds: partner A speaks for 1 minute presenting their evidence and claim; partner B speaks for 1 minute responding with their evidence and a short counterpoint. After both have spoken, allow 1 minute for both to prepare a 30-second joint conclusion that acknowledges at least one competing interpretation. Run the timer and signal when to switch.
- 4. After pairs finish, ask two pairs (choose volunteers or nominate) to read their joint conclusion aloud (30 seconds each). As they speak, record on the board one piece of evidence each pair used and one competing interpretation they acknowledged.
- 5. Conclude by reminding students the Tennis Court Oath, the Third Estate's break in May 1789, and the Bastille's symbolic fall on 14 July 1789; ask students to copy one line under their notes that connects their debate evidence to these events (30 seconds).

Student instructions:

- You are in a pair. Your teacher gave your pair a slip that assigns which side you argue: either 'Political/financial crisis' OR 'Social/economic pressures'.
- Step 1 (4 minutes): Use your textbook chapter to find two short pieces of evidence (one sentence each) that support your assigned side. Write each sentence on the slip under 'Text evidence 1' and 'Text evidence 2'.
- Step 2 (debate): Partner A speaks for 1 minute using both pieces of evidence to make a claim about why their factor was central. Partner B then speaks for 1 minute using their evidence to disagree and offer an alternative cause. After both speak, you have 1 minute to prepare a 30-second joint conclusion that names at least one piece of evidence the other side raised and one reason both factors mattered together.
- When finished, be ready to share your joint conclusion aloud if called on. Finally, write one sentence connecting your evidence to either the Estates-General/Third Estate actions, the Tennis Court Oath, or the storming of the Bastille.

Success looks like: Each pair has two written textbook sentences on their slip labeled 'Text evidence 1' and 'Text evidence 2'; During speaking time each partner gives a clear claim supported by at least one textbook sentence from their slip.; Joint conclusions named one piece of the other side's evidence and stated how two types of causes can combine (observed for chosen pairs or on the board list).

Support: If you cannot start, use this sentence frame and one worked example. Frame: 'I think X was central because the chapter says "____" (quote) which shows _____. Another example is "____" which shows _____.'

Worked example (for political/financial side): 'I think political and financial crises were central because the chapter says "the crown faced bankruptcy and indecisive policy" which shows the monarchy could not manage the crisis. Another example is "tax reforms failed and ministers resigned" which shows resistance to reform made the situation worse.' Partner with a stronger reader if needed.

Extension: Choose one event (Estates-General split, Tennis Court Oath, or Bastille). Using only the evidence you collected, write a 3-sentence argument that explains how your side's causes made that event more likely, and add one sentence that uses a competing interpretation from the other side to show cause and context together.

Checkpoint Questions

- [understand] Name two different kinds of crisis the chapter says contributed to 1789 becoming a breaking point, and give one specific piece of evidence (a fact or quote) for each kind you named.

Expected: Example: 'Financial crisis' — evidence: France faced a fiscal crisis that forced Louis XVI to call the Estates-General (chapter phrase: "called in 1789 to address the fiscal crisis"). 'Social crisis' — evidence: sharp inequalities between the three estates and widespread peasant hardship (chapter passage describing social tensions and burdens on the Third Estate).

- [understand] Briefly explain what the Third Estate did when the Estates-General met and why that mattered (one sentence).

Expected: The Third Estate broke away, verified its members, and declared itself the National Assembly, claiming to represent the nation; this mattered because it shifted authority from the Estates-General to a body committed to drafting a constitution.

- [understand] Why did people storm the Bastille on 14 July 1789, and why does the chapter say the event is more important as a symbol than for the facts of the prison itself?

Expected: People attacked the Bastille partly for weapons and to challenge royal authority; the chapter notes the prison actually held very few prisoners (about seven), so its fall mattered most because it represented popular resistance to the Ancien Régime and became a powerful political symbol.

Exit Ticket

In a short paragraph (3–5 sentences), explain how social, economic, financial and political problems combined to produce the crisis that led to the Revolution. Use at least two pieces of evidence or quotations from the chapter.

Success indicator: Response names at least two types of crisis (social, economic, financial, or political), links them briefly (e.g., fiscal trouble limited royal options; social inequality increased popular anger), and includes two explicit pieces of evidence or short quotations from the chapter (for example: reference to the fiscal crisis that led to calling the Estates-General; the Estates-General's 1789 convening or the small number of prisoners in the Bastille).

Homework

- Create a one-page timeline (6–8 entries) from the Estates-General convening to the Storming of the Bastille. For three entries cite a short chapter quote (2–6 words) that supports that event.
- Write a 150-word paragraph evaluating the claim: 'The Bastille was important mainly as a symbol.' Use the chapter evidence about the number of prisoners and about popular rumours to support your judgment.
- Find and copy one sentence from the chapter that shows resistance to reform (e.g., noble or royal indecision). Underline the phrase that shows resistance and write one sentence explaining why that phrase matters for how the crisis developed.

Estimated time: 40 min

Mentor Moment — When a Symbol Outgrows the Facts

A local history teacher once showed students a battered lock from a closed town gate. The object had never been used in a famous battle, but after students learned the stories about it, they treated it like a relic of resistance.

Takeaway: Symbols gain power from stories people tell; always compare the story to the factual record before making a judgment.

Period 2

Entry Ticket

Write one sentence: After the Bastille and the Tennis Court Oath, did the National Assembly mostly use violence or legal change to achieve its goals? Give the one-word answer ("Violence" or "Legal change") and one short reason.

Expected response: One word: either "Violence" or "Legal change" and a short reason. A common wrong answer is "Violence" with a reason like "people fought in the streets." A more accurate answer is "Legal change" because the Assembly passed laws such as the August Decrees and the Declaration of the Rights of Man.

Teacher Script

0-5 min: Collect entry tickets and set purpose

Collect the papers quickly. Read aloud two student answers that show each view: one that says "Violence" and one that says "Legal change." Say: "Today we will track how the National Assembly turned pressure from 1789 into laws — not to decide who was 'right' but to see which actions changed France's legal system. By the end you will make a short timeline showing three actions the Third Estate took between May 1789 and the Tennis Court Oath, and explain how later events made the king lose authority."

Board: Write the lesson purpose and the success criterion.

- Anticipate: What counts as a Third Estate action—does a crowd action count?
- Anticipate: Do we have to use the words 'Tennis Court Oath' exactly?
- Anticipate: Will we be tested on dates?

5-15 min: Explain the August Decrees and Declaration (direct teaching)

Say: "First: the August Decrees. I'll read the definition exactly as our source gives it." Read: "August Decrees: Decrees passed in 1789 that abolished feudalism, cancelled feudal dues and church tithes, and established legal equality." Pause and ask: "Which three concrete changes are named in this definition?" (Wait for answers: abolished feudalism; cancelled feudal dues and church tithes; established legal equality.) Then say: "Second: the Declaration of the Rights of Man and of the Citizen. It was published on 26 August 1789 and is a statement of principles used when drafting a constitution." Ask: "Is the Declaration itself the constitution?" If a student says yes, respond: "Good question—some people confuse them. The Declaration set principles; the constitution was still being drafted."

Board: Write the definition of August Decrees verbatim. Under it, write: "Declaration of the Rights of Man and of the Citizen — 26 Aug 1789: statement of principles, part of drafting a constitution."

- Anticipate: Does 'abolished feudalism' mean peasants got land immediately?
- Anticipate: Were church tithes cancelled for everyone or just some groups?
- Anticipate: If the Declaration is only principles, did it have legal force?

15-27 min: Group analysis: construct short timeline (source quotes)

Arrange students in groups of three. Give each group copies of short chapter quotes you have on your page: (1) calling of Estates-General (May 1789), (2) Third Estate declares itself National Assembly, (3) Tennis Court Oath. Instruct: "Use these quotes to make a 4-step timeline from

Estates-General to the Tennis Court Oath showing at least three concrete actions the Third Estate took. Write each action as one short sentence. You have 8 minutes. I will come to each group and ask you to read one sentence." Walk and listen. When a group is ready, ask them to read their timeline sentence by sentence and ask one probing question: "Which of these is an action by the Third Estate, and which is a reaction by others?"

Board: Draw a three-box timeline labeled: Estates-General -> National Assembly -> Tennis Court Oath. Leave space under each box for a student sentence in the class share.

- Anticipate: Do we have to use the exact quotes or can we paraphrase?
- Anticipate: Is 'declaring itself the National Assembly' really an action by the Third Estate?
- Anticipate: What counts as a 'concrete action'—speeches, votes, or physical gatherings?

27-34 min: Role play: Varennes and debate about the king's authority

Ask for two volunteers: one to be Louis XVI and one to be a National Constituent Assembly member. Read a short scripted prompt: "It is June 1791. The king tries to leave Paris. The Assembly hears the news." Instruct the 'king' to say one sentence claiming he needs to travel for safety; instruct the Assembly member to ask two questions that show suspicion (for example, "Why leave during a constitution draft?" and "Will you accept the new laws?"). After the role play, lead a 3-minute whole class question: "How did the flight to Varennes affect the king's authority?" Collect two quick reasons from volunteers.

Board: Under the timeline, write: "Louis XVI's flight to Varennes (June 1791) — royal family arrested; increased suspicion; undermined king's authority."

- Anticipate: Did Louis escape successfully later?
- Anticipate: Why would the king try to leave if the Assembly was making laws?
- Anticipate: Was the arrest legal?

34-40 min: Check understanding and consolidate (exit activity)

Ask students to write one sentence on a slip: name three actions the Third Estate took from Estates-General to Tennis Court Oath (use class timeline) and one short reason why the August Decrees mattered for equality. Collect slips. Then read aloud a strong example and a weak example. Say: "Remember: the Assembly used legal change — the August Decrees and the Declaration — to formalize demands. But when the king tried to flee in 1791, people lost trust and the constitutional monarchy began to fail. Next lesson we will track how that failure led to the Republic and the Reign of Terror."

Board: Write the exit prompt on the board for students to copy: "List 3 Third Estate actions (Estates-General -> Tennis Court Oath) + why August Decrees mattered for equality."

- Anticipate: Do we have to put dates on our slip?
- Anticipate: Will these slips be graded?
- Anticipate: Can we use the words 'abolished feudalism' exactly from the board?

Blackboard Notes

- This period: From August Decrees to Constitutional Monarchy
- Lesson purpose
- Key documents & events
- Timeline (class input)
- Exit task
- Lesson purpose: Track how the Assembly turned 1789 pressure into laws and how the

king's flight undermined his authority.

- Success criterion: Make a short timeline with 3 Third Estate actions (May 1789 -> Tennis Court Oath) and explain one impact of the August Decrees.
- August Decrees: Decrees passed in 1789 that abolished feudalism, cancelled feudal dues and church tithes, and established legal equality.
- Declaration of the Rights of Man and of the Citizen — published 26 Aug 1789: a statement of principles used when drafting a constitution.
- Constitutional monarchy phase (July 1789–2 Sept 1792): France had a constitution; rules limited who could vote (active vs passive citizens); political tensions grew.
- Louis XVI's flight to Varennes (June 1791): royal family arrested at Varennes; increased suspicion of the king; undermined his authority.
- Diagram: Three-box timeline: Estates-General -> National Assembly -> Tennis Court Oath. Underneath, add a fourth box later labeled: August Decrees / Declaration (Aug 1789).
- Diagram: Under the timeline, draw a short arrow from 'Varennes (June 1791)' to 'loss of royal authority' showing cause -> effect.

Activities

Tracing Actions: Third Estate from Estates-General to Constitutional Monarchy (12 min, group_discussion)

Materials: Copies of short primary excerpts (printed slips) — one excerpt per pair: Tennis Court Oath (abridged), August Decrees summary, Declaration of the Rights of Man excerpt, short account of the Flight to Varennes (all provided by the teacher), Blank timeline strip per group (one sheet of paper long enough for 6 boxes) or 6 sticky notes per group, Pens or pencils, Stopwatch or visible clock

1. Arrange students in pairs. Hand each pair one printed excerpt slip and one blank timeline strip or set of 6 sticky notes. Say: "You have 12 minutes. Use the excerpt you were given to identify the key action by the Third Estate and place it in the correct order on the timeline strip. Then prepare a one-sentence explanation that links that action to at least one of the four concepts listed on the wall: August Decrees, Declaration of the Rights of Man, Constitutional Monarchy period, or Flight to Varennes."
2. Tell pairs to spend the first 5 minutes reading their excerpt silently and underlining one sentence that shows an action taken by the Third Estate. If the excerpt does not name the Third Estate explicitly, they should note who acted (e.g., National Assembly) and why that counts as the Third Estate acting. Start the timer.
3. After 5 minutes, ask pairs to use the next 4 minutes to decide where their action fits in sequence (relative to calling of the Estates-General, Tennis Court Oath, creation of National Constituent Assembly, August Decrees, Declaration, Constitutional Monarchy, Flight to Varennes). They write a one-sentence explanation on their timeline box/sticky note and place it in order. Circulate; check that each pair points to the sentence they underlined as evidence for their chosen action.
4. In the final 3 minutes, ask pairs to swap their timeline quickly with a neighboring pair for a 30-second quick check: the neighbor reads the sentence and either nods or raises a hand if they think the placement is wrong. Return timelines. End by asking one or two pairs to read their one-sentence explanation aloud. Collect timelines or leave them displayed.
5. While students work, listen for pairs explicitly citing the excerpt sentence as evidence, and prompt any pair that treats events as single-cause stories to consider another

interpretation (for example: did the Declaration reflect consensus or were there further disputes?).

Student instructions:

- 1. In your pair, read the excerpt on your slip silently. Underline one sentence that shows a concrete action linked to the Revolution (for example: forming a new assembly, voting to abolish feudal dues, issuing a declaration, or arresting the king).
- 2. Decide together: what action does that sentence show the Third Estate (or the National Assembly) taking? Write a one-sentence explanation that names the action and links it to one of these concepts: August Decrees, Declaration of the Rights of Man, Constitutional Monarchy phase, or Flight to Varennes.
- 3. Put your one-sentence explanation on one box of the timeline strip or on one sticky note. Place it where you think it belongs in sequence from May 1789 (Estates-General called) to September 1792 (end of constitutional monarchy).
- 4. After placing it, be ready to point to the underlined sentence in the excerpt as the evidence for your placement when the teacher comes by or when a neighboring pair checks your work.

Success looks like: Each pair has an underlined sentence on their excerpt that they can point to as evidence for the action they named.; Each timeline box/sticky shows a one-sentence explanation that links the action to one of the four required concepts and is placed in a plausible sequence.; At least one pair can explain aloud how their cited sentence supports their placement when asked (reads the sentence and states the connection).

Support: Pair students heterogeneously so a stronger reader pairs with a weaker reader. Provide this sentence frame to use when writing the one-sentence explanation: "The Third Estate (or National Assembly) [action verb] by _____, which shows they were trying to _____ (link to one concept). Evidence: ' _____ ' (underlined excerpt)." As a worked example, show a filled box: "The National Assembly declared itself the law-making body (action) to end the old order (purpose). Evidence: 'The representatives of the Third Estate... constituted themselves a National Assembly.'"

Extension: Choose one event on the class timeline and write a two-sentence alternative interpretation that challenges the simple cause-effect story. For example: argue that the Declaration of the Rights of Man reflected ongoing political conflict rather than full agreement — name one line of evidence from other events (like the August Decrees or the Flight to Varennes) that supports your alternative interpretation.

Checkpoint Questions

- [analyze] List three concrete actions the Third Estate took between the Estates-General meeting and the Tennis Court Oath. Be specific about what each action did.

Expected: Answers should name three actions such as: (1) Declared itself the National Assembly — it claimed the right to represent the nation and to make laws rather than leaving power to the Estates-General structure. (2) Refused to meet separately by order and instead sat together — this broke the old voting-by-estate procedure and pushed for voting by head. (3) Took the Tennis Court Oath — they vowed not to separate until they had written a constitution, signalling a formal commitment to constitutional change. Each action must be tied to its political effect (claiming authority; changing voting rules; committing to a written constitution).

- [analyze] How did the Tennis Court Oath change the balance of power between the king and the Third Estate? Give one specific consequence within the next weeks.

Expected: Expected answer: The Oath shifted authority toward the Third Estate by presenting the Assembly as the source of law-making and by publicly refusing to disband without a constitution; a specific consequence was increased popular support and pressure that helped produce the August Decrees and the Declaration of the

Rights of Man as legal changes that limited traditional royal and aristocratic privileges.

- [analyze] Explain one reason why Louis XVI's flight to Varennes (June 1791) weakened the constitutional monarchy that the Assembly was building.

Expected: Expected answer: The flight made many people see the king as untrustworthy and possibly opposed to the Revolution; this loss of trust reduced the monarchy's legitimacy and increased calls for stronger limits on the king, contributing to the collapse of the constitutional monarchy by 1792.

Exit Ticket

Create a short timeline (4–6 bullets) from the calling of the Estates-General through the Tennis Court Oath to the National Constituent Assembly. For each bullet, name the Third Estate action and one direct political effect of that action.

Success indicator: Timeline has 4–6 dated or ordered bullets; each bullet names a Third Estate action (e.g., declaring the National Assembly, refusing separate meetings, Tennis Court Oath) and links that action to a direct political effect (e.g., claiming legislative authority, changing voting rules, committing to a constitution or increasing popular pressure).

Homework

- Make a one-page timeline (handwritten or digital) from May 1789 to June 1791 that includes at least six entries. For each entry write one sentence connecting the Third Estate's action to a political effect.
- Write a short paragraph (120–180 words) answering: 'How did the August Decrees and the Declaration of the Rights of Man change legal equality in France?' Use one quote from the period text in class or the definitions provided.
- Prepare one open question about why the constitutional monarchy failed (to bring to the next lesson).

Estimated time: 40 min

Mentor Moment — A classroom split and a stronger argument

In one class, students first argued in separate groups until a small team refused to leave the central table and wrote their position on the board. That visible claim rallied others and turned a loose argument into a class decision.

Takeaway: Standing your ground with a clear written claim can change who controls a discussion — show the action and explain its effect.

Period 3

Entry Ticket

Write one sentence answering: What do you think the "Reign of Terror" was for the French Revolution — a necessary defence, a government mistake, or something else? Add one specific example or image you associate with that phrase.

Expected response: A short sentence naming one view (e.g., "a necessary defence") plus one example or image (e.g., "the guillotine").

Teacher Script

0-4 min: Collect entry tickets and quick share

Ask students to hand in or hold up their one-sentence tickets. Read aloud 3 different answers you collected that represent different views: one that calls the Terror necessary, one that calls it a mistake, and one that gives a different idea. Say: "Keep those reactions in mind — today we'll use facts to test these quick impressions." Tell students: "If your answer mentioned the guillotine, assignats, or a name (Robespierre, Danton, Hébert), listen for where that appears in the facts I will give."

Board: Write three labels horizontally: "Necessary defence", "Government mistake", "Other" and jot one short example under each as you read the student answers.

- Anticipate: Will we be graded on the ticket? (No — it's just for thinking.)
- Anticipate: Can I change my view later? (Yes — we'll compare ideas to facts.)
- Anticipate: What counts as an example? (Any short image, name, or event you associate.)

4-13 min: Introduce key facts: Republic, calendar, assignats

Say: "I will list the main facts you must remember. Listen and copy exactly what I put on the board." Read each fact slowly and point to the board lines as you write them. Say the date aloud when you write it. Use these sentences to read: 1) "22 September 1792: The Convention declared the French First Republic and started a new calendar, beginning Year One (1792)." 2) "Assignats: A paper currency backed by confiscated church property used by the revolutionary government." 3) "Assignats were meant to fix finances but led to rising prices and inflation before later monetary changes." Pause after each sentence to let students copy. When you write "inflation," give a quick concrete example: "Bread prices rising so wages buy less."

Board: Write the three full sentences exactly as read. Underline the words: "Year One (1792)", "Assignats", and "inflation".

- Anticipate: Did the new calendar replace months and weekdays? (Yes — the Convention introduced a new calendar; we are only noting that Year One began in 1792.)
- Anticipate: Were assignats real money? (Yes — they were paper currency backed by church property.)
- Anticipate: If assignats were backed by land, why did they cause inflation? (Students often ask this; say: we'll explore that in the discussion — the confiscated assets did not stop prices rising when too many assignats circulated.)

13-24 min: Describe the Reign of Terror facts and figures

Read this paragraph aloud while pointing to the board: "Reign of Terror (approx. Sept 1793 to July 1794): revolutionary governments used emergency laws, mass arrests and executions against perceived enemies. Important measures included the Law of Suspects and the Law of 22 Prairial. Violence included public executions by guillotine, drownings at Nantes, the execution of prominent Hébertists and Danton, and eventually the execution of Robespierre." After reading, ask: "Which of those items names a law, which names people, which names methods of execution?" Call on volunteers and prompt them to point at the words on the board. Then say: "These are the measures and human costs you must be able to summarise."

Board: Write the sentence for "Reign of Terror" as given in the definitions. Below it list: "Law of Suspects", "Law of 22 Prairial", "Guillotine (symbol of the Terror)", "Drownings at Nantes", "Executions of Hébertists and Danton", "Execution of Robespierre".

- Anticipate: What exactly did the Law of Suspects do? (It authorised arrests of people suspected of opposing the Revolution; details will be discussed in sources later.)
- Anticipate: Who were the Hébertists and Danton? (Short answer: political group/members; Danton was a leading revolutionary; both were executed during the Terror.)
- Anticipate: Was Robespierre only a victim? (Students may ask; say: he was a leader associated with the Terror and was executed in July 1794.)

24-30 min: Group discussion: competing interpretations with evidence

Put students in groups of 3. Give this instruction aloud and post it on the board: "Each group: pick one view from the opening tickets (necessary, mistake, or other). Spend 5 minutes finding two facts on the board that best support that view and one fact that challenges it. Appoint one speaker for your group." Walk around and listen. After 5 minutes call two groups to report: ask the speaker to name their chosen view, the two supporting facts, and the one challenging fact. If a group chooses "assignats solved the crisis," ask them to find the board line that says assignats caused inflation.

Board: Add the instruction: "Group task: 2 supporting facts + 1 challenging fact. Choose a speaker." Leave previous facts visible.

- Anticipate: Can we use outside facts? (Use only the facts on the board for this task.)
- Anticipate: How long should the speaker speak? (About 30 seconds.)
- Anticipate: What if we disagree in the group? (Pick one view to represent and note the disagreement briefly.)

30-36 min: Role-play courtroom: who is responsible?

Explain: "We will do a quick 5-minute courtroom. I will be the judge who times speakers. You need three roles: prosecutor (blames revolutionary government), defender (blames external threats/war), and witness (reads a fact from the board). Groups of 4 will send one representative to a single court in front of the class. Each role gets 40 seconds. Prosecutor must cite at least one law or method from the board. Defender must cite at least one cause (use the Republic claim or external threat). Witness reads a fact exactly from the board." Run two short courts with volunteers. Prompt speakers: "Cite the board line you're using." After both courts, ask the class: "Which side used the Law of Suspects or assignats as evidence?"

Board: Write the role list and timing: "Prosecutor 40s, Defender 40s, Witness reads board fact 40s". Keep facts visible.

- Anticipate: Can we use notes? (Yes — but only from what you've copied from the board.)
- Anticipate: What if we run out of time? (Keep arguments short — one clear point with one board fact.)

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Anticipate: Can the witness read more than one fact? (Stick to one clear fact to keep timing fair.)

36-40 min: Check understanding and consolidate

Say: "Quick check: write one sentence that answers: Between Sept 1793 and July 1794, what measures were used and what were the human costs? Use at least one number or specific name from the board (for example: Law of 22 Prairial, Robespierre, or assignats)." Give 2 minutes to write. Then ask three students to read theirs aloud. End by summarising: "The Convention proclaimed the Republic on 22 Sept 1792. The Reign of Terror used emergency laws, mass arrests and executions (Sept 1793–July 1794). Assignats were paper money backed by church land but led to inflation."

Board: Add the prompt for the one-sentence check and underline the words: "Sept 1793 to July 1794" and "use at least one name or number."

- Anticipate: Do we have to include exact dates? (Include the period Sept 1793 to July 1794 if you can.)
- Anticipate: What counts as a number? (A date or the name of a law or person from the board.)
- Anticipate: Will we keep these notes? (Yes — copy the board before you leave.)

Blackboard Notes

- 22 September 1792 — Republic declared
- Assignats
- Reign of Terror (approx. Sept 1793 to July 1794)
- Key measures and events
- 22 September 1792: The Convention declared the French First Republic and started a new calendar, beginning Year One (1792).
- Assignats: A paper currency backed by confiscated church property used by the revolutionary government.
- Assignats were meant to fix finances but led to rising prices and inflation before later monetary changes.
- Reign of Terror: The period (approx. Sept 1793 to July 1794) when revolutionary governments used emergency laws, mass arrests, and executions against perceived enemies of the Revolution.
- Important measures and events:
 - - Law of Suspects (authorised arrests of suspected opponents)
 - - Law of 22 Prairial (expanded procedures for conviction and execution)
 - - Guillotine: Execution device invented during the Revolution; became the principal symbol of the Terror
 - - Drownings at Nantes (mass executions by drowning)
 - - Executions of Hébertists and Danton (prominent political figures executed during the Terror)
 - - Execution of Robespierre (July 1794) — end of the main Terror period
- Diagram: A simple horizontal timeline from 1792 to 1794 marking: '22 Sept 1792: Republic proclaimed', 'Sept 1793: start of main Terror measures', 'July 1794: execution of Robespierre — Terror ends'.

Activities

Convention Debate: Republic, Assignats, and the Terror (12 min, role_play)

Materials: Printed role slip per student (4 roles per group) — teacher prepares 1 set per group in 10 minutes, One copy per group of a short factsheet (one-sided) summarising: proclamation of the Republic (22 Sep 1792, Year I), assignats (backed by confiscated church property), Law of Suspects, Law of 22 Prairial, drownings at Nantes, executions of Hébertists, Danton, and Robespierre, dates for the Reign of Terror (Sept 1793–2 July 1794), Timer or stopwatch (phone), Small paper and pen per student, Optional: classroom whiteboard or chart paper for quick group notes

- 1. Arrange students into groups of four. Give each student one role slip and each group one factsheet. Say: “You are delegates in the National Convention in late 1793. Your job is to prepare a 60–90 second statement from your role’s perspective about the Republic’s recent measures (assignats, emergency laws) and the human costs of the Terror.” Start the timer for 2 minutes of preparation.
- 2. While groups prepare, circulate to check they use only evidence on the factsheet and to prompt with two questions if stuck: “Which measure on the factsheet supports your view?” and “Name one human cost from the factsheet you want to highlight.” Do not give new facts.
- 3. After 2 minutes, call groups to perform. Each group has 6 minutes total: each of the four students speaks for 60–90 seconds in role (teacher times with stopwatch). Announce: “Begin the Convention statements now.” While groups perform, take quick notes of which facts each student cites.
- 4. After all groups present (or after 6 minutes of presentations if rotating groups), give each group 3 minutes to prepare a one-sentence group resolution that summarises the main measures and human costs they agree on using only items from the factsheet. Then ask one group volunteer to read the resolution aloud.
- 5. Close by reading aloud (or pointing to) one competing interpretation: e.g., “Some delegates argue assignats were necessary to stabilise finance; others say they created inflation and did not solve the crisis.” Ask students to listen for which side used which piece of evidence during presentations.

Student instructions:

- You are a delegate in the National Convention in late 1793. Read your role slip and the factsheet.
- You have 2 minutes to prepare one 60–90 second statement in role. Use only the factsheet for facts and the role’s viewpoint to choose which facts to stress.
- When it is your turn (each group has 6 minutes total), speak in character for 60–90 seconds. Say one clear claim (e.g., ‘We must keep the Law of Suspects’) and cite at least one specific item from the factsheet (date, law name, or event).
- After all four in your group speak, work together for 3 minutes to write one sentence that summarises, using the factsheet, the Convention’s main measures and the human costs of the Terror that you can all agree on.
- Be ready to read your group’s one-sentence resolution aloud.

Success looks like: Each student speaker cites at least one specific item from the factsheet (for example: ‘Law of Suspects’, ‘assignats backed by confiscated church property’, ‘22 September 1792, Year I’, or named events like ‘drownings at Nantes’); Each group produces a one-sentence resolution that mentions at least one measure

(assignats, emergency laws, or proclamation of the Republic) and at least one human cost (mass arrests/executions, named executions, or Law of 22 Prairial).; At least two different groups present competing interpretations (for example: one group defends assignats as necessary while another highlights negative consequences).

Support: If you are unsure how to start, use this sentence frame: "As a [role], I support/oppose [measure from factsheet] because [brief factual reason from factsheet]." Example worked first statement for a Moderate deputy: "As a moderate deputy, I accept the proclamation of the Republic on 22 September 1792 (Year I) but worry that the Law of Suspects leads to too many arrests without fair trials." Pair a struggling student with a stronger reader in the same group if needed.

Extension: Challenge question for early finishers: Prepare a 90–120 second mini-argument (in role) that compares two competing interpretations of assignats: one that says they solved the fiscal crisis by using confiscated church property, and one that says they caused long-term economic problems. Cite at least two items from the factsheet as evidence and propose one additional primary-source question you would ask to decide between these interpretations.

Checkpoint Questions

- [understand] Name two legal measures used by revolutionary governments during the Reign of Terror and briefly say what each did.

Expected: Law of Suspects — allowed wide arrest of those 'suspected' of opposing the Revolution; Law of 22 Prairial — sped up trials and reduced defendants' rights, increasing the rate of convictions and executions.

- [understand] Give two specific examples of the human costs or acts of repression the text mentions during the Terror.

Expected: Drownings at Nantes; executions of the Hébertists and of Danton; execution of Robespierre are all named examples of large-scale violence and executions.

- [understand] What were assignats and what negative economic effect associated with them does the chapter link to the Revolution?

Expected: Assignats were a paper currency backed by confiscated church property. The text links assignats to escalating inflation and the need for price controls, showing they contributed to severe inflation and economic dislocation.

Exit Ticket

In one short paragraph, summarise the main legal measures and the human costs of the Reign of Terror, using at least two specific examples named in the text.

Success indicator: A correct response names at least two legal measures (for example: Law of Suspects, Law of 22 Prairial, emergency laws, mass arrests) and at least two specific examples of human costs cited in the text (for example: drownings at Nantes; executions of the Hébertists, Danton, or Robespierre). It may also note assignats' link to inflation.

Homework

- Write a one-page summary (250–300 words) that explains how the Convention moved from declaring the Republic to using emergency laws — include the names of at least three measures or events from the period.
- Find one primary-source quotation from a Revolutionary figure about the Terror (teacher-approved list or class reader) and write 4–6 sentences explaining how that quote

supports or challenges the interpretation that the Terror was an emergency response rather than planned mass repression.

Estimated time: 45 min

Mentor Moment — When a courtroom decision changes everything

A young law student I knew volunteered at a local historical society exhibit on trials; seeing how procedures were shortened in emergency times, she realised small legal changes can let violence scale quickly.

Takeaway: Pay attention to how changes in law (shorter trials, broader definitions of 'suspect') can change outcomes far faster than single events.

Period 4

Entry Ticket

Write one short sentence answering: Which caused more of the French Revolution's actions between 1789–1799 — Enlightenment ideas (political theory) or immediate practical problems (money, food, war)? Then write one reason for your choice. Be honest — there are no right or wrong grades.

Expected response: One sentence choosing either 'Enlightenment ideas' or 'practical problems', plus one brief reason (e.g. 'Enlightenment ideas because the Declaration inspired action' or 'practical problems because money and war forced decisions').

Teacher Script

0-4 min: Collect entry tickets and show common answers

Collect the quick sentences. While you hand them in, read three aloud (pick one that says 'ideas', one that says 'problems', and one in between). Say: 'Thanks. You can keep thinking about that question. For today we will compare those two views using the chapter's evidence.'

Board: Write two column headers: 'Ideas' and 'Practical problems'. Under each, leave space for students to add one example later.

- Anticipate: Do we have to defend our choice? (No — just write your best immediate thought.)
- Anticipate: Can I change my answer later? (Yes — the class will discuss different views.)

4-12 min: Introduce the Directory and the historical problem

Hold up the chapter and point to the heading 'Directory (1795–1799)'. Say: 'The Directory governed after the Reign of Terror. It had a weak executive—five directors—and a two-house legislature. It faced political unrest, economic weakness, and relied on the army. Today we will see how war and money problems shaped the Directory and how historians disagree about ideas vs. problems.' Read aloud this one-sentence summary from the chapter: 'The Directory was weak, corrupt, and dependent on the army.' Then ask: 'What would a government dependent on the army look like? Give one quick idea.' Call on two students to answer.

Board: Under the earlier headings add one short line under the board's middle area: 'Directory: 5 directors; bicameral legislature; weak executive; relied on the army; corruption'.

- Anticipate: Was the Directory the same as a king? (No — it was an executive collective of five directors, not a monarch.)
- Anticipate: Why five directors? (The chapter explains this was designed to avoid a single ruler after the Terror.)

12-20 min: Compare two interpretations about ideology vs pragmatism

Say: 'Now we compare two interpretations the chapter gives.' Read or paraphrase the two short positions: 1) 'Radical Enlightenment view: Enlightenment ideas — rights and popular sovereignty — motivated many revolutionary actions.' 2) 'Pragmatic response view: Immediate fiscal crisis, food shortages, and war forced many decisions more than pure theory.' For each view ask the class to give one piece of evidence the chapter uses. Pause and point at the page: 'For the ideas

view the chapter cites Enlightenment authors and the Declaration. For the pragmatic view the chapter cites tax crisis, Assignats, and mobilization for war.' Ask students to turn to a partner and agree on one sentence evidence for each view. After 90 seconds, ask two pairs to share. Board: Under 'Ideas' write one evidence: 'Declaration of the Rights of Man; Enlightenment authors cited.' Under 'Practical problems' write one evidence: 'Fiscal crisis, Assignats, food shortages, war mobilization.'

- Anticipate: Is the chapter saying one view is right? (No — it presents both as competing interpretations.)
- Anticipate: Which view do most historians accept? (Historians disagree; the chapter says both matter.)
- Anticipate: What is an Assignat again? (A paper currency backed by confiscated church property — taught earlier.)

20-28 min: Guided preparation for a short debate in groups

Explain the quick task: 'In your groups of four, pick one side: Ideas or Practical problems. Use the chapter's evidence to prepare two short points: one piece of evidence and one explanation of why it shows your side matters. I will give you a minute to choose and eight minutes to prepare.' Hand out or point to two figures in the chapter that show army size and conscription change; say: 'Use those figures to support the 'practical problems' side if you can.' Walk the room, listening, and prompt one group with: 'Which figure from the chapter backs your claim? Read the caption aloud.'

Board: Write on the board: 'Debate task: 2 points — evidence + explanation. Use chapter figures on army size and conscription.'

- Anticipate: Can we use both sides' evidence? (You must pick a side, but you can explain why the other side might also have a point.)
- Anticipate: What figures on army size? (The chapter's figures showing troop increases and conscription — point to the figures in the chapter.)
- Anticipate: Can one person be the speaker? (Yes — choose one presenter for your group.)

28-33 min: Structured mini-debate and small-group reflection

Call three groups to present: one group arguing 'Ideas', one arguing 'Practical problems', and one that split the difference. Each group has one minute to speak. After each presentation, ask the class one quick question: 'What single piece of evidence did they use?' After the three, ask: 'Who changed their mind from the entry ticket? Raise your hand if you did.'

Board: Create a quick tally column: 'Changed mind' and mark tallies as students raise hands.

- Anticipate: What if our group runs out of time? (Say the key point quickly — evidence then why it matters.)
- Anticipate: Do we need to mention the Directory now? (Yes — tie your point to how these causes affected the Directory.)

33-39 min: Role play to show how wartime mobilization changed politics, then check

Set up role play: 'Five volunteers will be 'Directors'. Two will be 'army commanders'. The rest decide quickly: will you support calling more troops or refusing? Directors must decide by a show of hands. Use the chapter figures (I will point at them) showing troop growth to imagine pressure on directors. Run the role play for three minutes. Then ask: 'How did reliance on the army shape the directors' choices?' End with a two-minute consolidation: ask one student to state one sentence describing how wartime mobilization changed military scale and one sentence about how that affected politics — and to cite 'the chapter's figures' or the chapter as

the source.

Board: Underneath the Directory summary add: 'Wartime mobilization -> larger army; political reliance on army; quicker coups (e.g. 18 Brumaire).' Add a short line: 'Check: cite the chapter's figures on troop growth.'

- Anticipate: Do we need exact numbers for troop growth? (For now cite the chapter's figures — later you will copy exact numbers for homework.)
- Anticipate: Why did directors fear the army? (Because the chapter shows the Directory depended on military force to govern and to put down unrest.)
- Anticipate: What is 18 Brumaire? (A later coup that overthrew the Directory — taught in a later period.)

39-40 min: Final check and consolidation

Ask: 'In one sentence: does the chapter present ideology as the sole cause or a contested cause? And give one piece of evidence for both sides.' Call on two students. Then say: 'Tonight: read the chapter figures on conscription and troop numbers and bring one exact figure each for tomorrow.' Collect any last questions and dismiss.

Board: Write as the exit prompt: 'Exit: ideology contested. Evidence (ideas) — Declaration; (problems) — fiscal crisis, Assignats, war mobilization. Bring one exact figure on troop numbers for homework.'

- Anticipate: What if we can't find the exact figures tonight? (Bring an approximate number and the page number; we will check together.)
- Anticipate: Is this graded? (This is for learning and for tomorrow's discussion.)

Blackboard Notes

- Ideas vs Practical problems
- Directory (1795–1799)
- Debate evidence
- Quick check / Exit
- Directory: five directors; bicameral legislature; weak executive; relied on the army; corruption
- Ideas — evidence: Declaration of the Rights of Man; Enlightenment authors cited in chapter
- Practical problems — evidence: fiscal crisis, Assignats, food shortages, wartime mobilization (chapter's figures show troop increase)
- Wartime mobilization -> larger army; political reliance on army; faster use of military to resolve politics; leads to 18 Brumaire
- Exit: Chapter presents ideology as contested, not sole cause. Bring one exact troop figure from the chapter for tomorrow
- Diagram: Simple two-column table labelled 'Ideas' and 'Practical problems' with one evidence point under each
- Diagram: A small arrow diagram: 'War mobilization' -> 'More soldiers (see chapter's figures)' -> 'More political power for generals/army' -> 'Directory relies on army'

Activities

Gallery Walk: Two Interpretations and Wartime Change (10 min, gallery_walk)

Materials: Class set of the chapter (one per student) or projected excerpts, 4 sheets of chart paper taped to walls or desks, Markers (at least one per pair), Printed slip per pair with two prompts (see teacher) — can be photocopied in 5 minutes, Timer or stopwatch

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1. Before class tape four chart papers around the room and write one heading on each: A) 'Enlightenment-driven view', B) 'Pragmatic/Immediate Causes view', C) 'Wartime mobilization: scale & figures (1792–1795)', D) 'Questions & competing evidence'. Place one printed prompt slip at each paper for the first pair; give each pair one slip when they start.
- 2. Tell students: 'You will do a 10-minute gallery walk in pairs. At each station you will read the prompt, find one piece of evidence in the chapter that supports the heading, and write a short sentence on the chart naming the evidence and which page/paragraph it came from. Rotate every 2 minutes so each pair visits all four stations.' Assign students into pairs and hand each pair a copy of the printed prompt slip and a marker.
- 3. Start the timer for 2-minute rotations. At each rotation announce verbally 'Rotate' and cue pairs to move clockwise. While students move, circulate quickly: listen for one sentence from a pair at a station, check that they cite a specific line or figure from the chapter, and remind them to write the page/paragraph number with their sentence.
- 4. After the four rotations (8 minutes of stations plus 2 minutes for transitions = 10 minutes), ask pairs to return to seats. Spend the final minute asking two pairs to read aloud one evidence sentence they wrote for station A and one for station C. Collect chart papers or leave them visible for later reference.

Student instructions:

- 1. Work with your partner. You will visit four stations for 2 minutes each. At each station read the heading and the short prompt on the slip.
- 2. Use the chapter in front of you (or the projected excerpt) to find one specific piece of evidence that supports the station heading. Evidence can be a quoted phrase, a named event or a figure (e.g., numbers of soldiers, dates), and you must write the page or paragraph number after your sentence.
- 3. On the chart paper write one clear sentence: say which interpretation or fact the evidence supports and give the citation. Example: 'The chapter quotes a deputy saying "rights" were the goal (p. 42, para. 3) — supports Enlightenment-driven view.'
- 4. After 2 minutes, rotate to the next station clockwise until you have visited all four. At the last station add one short question about conflicting evidence for classmates to answer later.

Success looks like: At each station most chart entries name a specific piece of evidence from the chapter and include a page or paragraph citation.; Pairs can be heard briefly explaining to the teacher which line or figure in the chapter supports the sentence they write.; The 'Wartime mobilization' station contains at least two entries that cite chapter figures (e.g., numbers of troops, years, or territorial gains) rather than only general statements. Support: Pair lower-readiness students with a stronger reader. Give that pair a worked example card: 'Worked example (station A): "The chapter records Robespierre invoking 'natural rights' in his speech (p. 18, para. 2) — evidence for Enlightenment influence.'" Also provide a reduced task: at two stations (A and C) they only need to find one highlighted sentence in the chapter and copy it with the citation.

Extension: Choose one piece of evidence you found that could support more than one interpretation. Write a 6–8 sentence paragraph (to be handed in) that explains which interpretation that evidence supports best, and then present an alternative interpretation using a different piece of evidence from the charts. Cite both locations in the chapter.

Checkpoint Questions

- [understand] State, in one sentence, the two competing interpretations the chapter gives for what drove the Revolution: (a) the ideology view and (b) the pragmatic-crisis view.

Expected: Ideology view: Enlightenment ideas and radical political thought motivated revolutionary change.

Pragmatic-crisis view: Immediate fiscal collapse, food shortages, and political conflicts forced practical responses that drove actions more than pure ideology.

- [understand] Give one piece of evidence the chapter uses to support the idea that wartime mobilization changed the French army's scale or political power between 1792 and 1795.

Expected: The chapter cites figures showing the army grew from small professional forces to a mass conscripted force (chapter figures): dramatically increased troop numbers and budgets, and reliance on levée en masse that made generals politically important.

- [understand] Using the Directory as described in the chapter, name one institutional weakness and one political consequence of that weakness.

Expected: Institutional weakness: a weak executive of five directors with a bicameral legislature that produced slow decision-making. Political consequence: reliance on the army and corruption increased, producing chronic violence and the conditions for 18 Brumaire.

Exit Ticket

In one short paragraph, compare the chapter's two interpretations about whether Enlightenment ideology or pragmatic crises best explain revolutionary actions. Give one specific piece of evidence from the chapter that the authors use for each interpretation. Then, in two sentences, describe how wartime mobilization changed the French military and political dynamics between 1792 and 1795, citing at least one figure or quantitative point the chapter gives.

Success indicator: One paragraph that: (1) names both interpretations and gives one distinct chapter-cited piece of evidence for each; (2) then two sentences describing how mobilization expanded the army and shifted politics, and includes at least one chapter figure or quantitative point (for example troop numbers, percentage growth, or budget increase) to support the claim.

Homework

- Write a 250-word paragraph that evaluates which interpretation (ideology or pragmatic crisis) you find more convincing for the period 1789–1795. Use two specific pieces of evidence from the chapter — one supporting each interpretation — and explain which evidence you trust more and why.
- Create a 90-second audio or written summary that explains how wartime mobilization changed the size of the French army and its political role. Include the chapter figure(s) you will quote in class.
- Bring one question about the Directory's reliance on the army or about the ideology debate to the next lesson to discuss in small groups.

Estimated time: 40 min

Mentor Moment — When historians argue in public

A teacher once brought two short historian quotes to class that disagreed about whether ideas or crisis mattered more. Students argued louder than usual, but then used chapter evidence to change minds respectfully.

Takeaway: Disagreement is normal in history; use the chapter's evidence to support your view, and listen for good evidence in opposing arguments.

Period 5

Entry Ticket

Write one short sentence answering both parts: (A) How many prisoners were held in the Bastille when it was stormed? (B) Was the Bastille more important because of the number of prisoners or because of what it symbolised?

Expected response: A: Seven prisoners. B: It was more important as a symbol of the Ancien Régime than for the number of prisoners.

Teacher Script

0-6 min: Collect entry tickets and surface the Bastille myth

Ask students to hold up their paper. Read aloud three student sentences (one that says many prisoners, two that say few or symbolic). Say: "We will start by checking these answers against the chapter. Tell me: how many prisoners does the chapter report?" Pause for answers. If a student says 'many', show the correction: "The chapter reports only seven prisoners." Then say: "Write down the short phrase I give you: 'Bastille = symbol more than prison.' We will return to why symbols can beat facts."

Board: Write the short phrase: Bastille = symbol more than prison. Underline 'symbol'.

- Anticipate: Did the chapter actually say seven? Why that exact number?
- Anticipate: If there were only seven, why did people attack it?
- Anticipate: Is this why people later remember it differently?

6-16 min: Introduce Thermidorian reaction and recent changes

Say: "Now I will describe the political shifts after Robespierre. Listen for actions and for where they happened." Read aloud a short list: "revenge killings in southern France; executions of Commune leaders; repeal of the Law of 22 Prairial; closure of the Jacobin Club; negotiated peace treaties." After reading, point at each item and ask: "Which of these sounds like reversing radical Terror policies? Which sounds like moving toward compromise?" Call on two volunteers to answer. Then say: "Keep these as examples of Thermidorian reaction: it was a political turn and a mix of revenge and negotiation."

Board: Write heading: Thermidorian reaction. Bullet list with the five items: revenge killings (south), executions of Commune leaders, repeal of Law of 22 Prairial, closure of Jacobin Club, negotiated peace treaties.

- Anticipate: What was the Law of 22 Prairial?
- Anticipate: Who were the Commune leaders?
- Anticipate: Do 'negotiated peace treaties' mean France stopped fighting?

16-28 min: Guided role play: metropolitan debates and the colonies (focus on Saint-Domingue)

Explain the activity: "You will role-play four groups for four minutes each: (1) metropolitan abolitionists, (2) metropolitan pro-slavery planters, (3) commissioners in Saint-Domingue, (4) enslaved rebels in Saint-Domingue. I will give each group one sentence from the chapter to read and one action to propose." Hand out short slips (read these aloud if necessary): Abolitionists: argue for universal rights; Planters: argue for property and order; Commissioners: report on

uprisings and try negotiated measures; Rebels: demand freedom and resist limits. Tell each group to pick one short sentence to say to the class. After four minutes, each group speaks one line in order. After the role play, ask: "According to the chapter, what legal step did the Convention take in 1794?" (pause) Confirm: abolition of slavery in 1794, but enforcement and restrictions varied. End with: "Note how metropolitan debates changed practical policy in the colonies."

Board: Draw four labeled boxes: Abolitionists, Planters, Commissioners, Rebels. Under each box, write one short phrase the groups used in their role lines.

- Anticipate: Did abolitionists win immediately?
- Anticipate: If the Convention abolished slavery, why were there still restrictions?
- Anticipate: What did the commissioners do exactly in Saint-Domingue?

28-34 min: Explain economic measures: church property, assignats, and inflation

Say: "Listen while I connect three facts from the chapter: confiscation of church lands, use of those lands to back assignats, and the inflation that followed." Point to the board items you will write. Read aloud a clear causal sequence: confiscate church land -> issue assignats to raise revenue -> assignats circulate as paper money -> widespread inflation and economic disruption. Ask: "What practical problem did the chapter give for implementing the August Decrees on tithes and feudal dues?" Wait for answers; prompt with: "Think of local records, people resisting, or unclear land ownership." Confirm the chapter mentions practical difficulties collecting or enforcing the new rules. Emphasize later stabilization: mention Franc germinal in 1803 as later monetary reform but do not explain beyond the name and date.

Board: Write heading: Economic policies & consequences. Bullets: abolition of tithes; nationalisation of church lands; assignats issued -> inflation; end of guilds and tax farming; later Franc germinal (1803).

- Anticipate: Why did assignats cause inflation if they were backed by land?
- Anticipate: What were the August Decrees exactly?
- Anticipate: Did everyone accept confiscation of church lands?

34-40 min: Check for understanding and consolidate the four objectives

Say: "We will check the four objectives from the chapter. I will read each objective and you give a one-sentence answer aloud." Read objective 1: Bastille symbol — call on a volunteer to answer. Read objective 2: August Decrees legal changes and one implementation difficulty — call a different volunteer. Read objective 3: relationship of church confiscation, assignats, and inflation — call another volunteer. Read objective 4: metropolitan debates and colonial policy 1791–1793 — call a final volunteer. After each response, give a one-sentence correction or praise, grounding each claim in the chapter wording. Finish with: "Two quick facts to copy from the board before you go."

Board: Underline four objective labels already present on the board and add a two-item 'Copy before leaving' list: (1) Bastille = symbol not mass prison (7 prisoners), (2) Convention abolished slavery 1794 but enforcement varied.

- Anticipate: Do we need to memorise the year 1794 for slavery?
- Anticipate: Can you repeat the one practical example of difficulty with August Decrees?
- Anticipate: Will there be a document question about the Bastille?

Blackboard Notes

- Bastille = symbol more than prison
- Thermidorian reaction
- Colonies & Saint-Domingue (1791–1793)
- Economic policies & consequences
- Copy before leaving
- Bastille held only seven prisoners — importance largely symbolic
- Thermidorian reaction: revenge killings (south); executions of Commune leaders; repeal of Law of 22 Prairial; closure of Jacobin Club; negotiated peace treaties
- Colonial tensions: abolitionist vs pro-slavery groups; uprisings in Saint-Domingue; commissioners tried measures; Convention abolished slavery in 1794 — enforcement and restrictions varied
- Economic changes: abolition of tithes; nationalisation of church lands; assignats issued (backed by confiscated lands) -> severe inflation and disruption; end of guilds and tax farming; later monetary stabilisation with Franc germinal (1803)
- Definitions: La Marseillaise (1792; adopted 1795); Guillotine (symbol of the Terror); Liberty cap (Phrygian cap); Cockade (tricolore)
- Practical difficulty with August Decrees: local enforcement and unclear ownership made collection of dues/tithes hard
- Diagram: Four boxes labeled: Abolitionists | Planters | Commissioners | Rebels (write one short phrase under each after role play)
- Diagram: Simple flow arrow: Church lands confiscated -> Assignats issued -> Assignats circulate -> Inflation rises

Activities

Revolutionary Aftershocks Walk-and-Record (12 min, field_task)

Materials: one printed slip per pair with four short prompts (teacher prepares in 5–10 minutes), clipboards or hard surface for writing (or textbook as lap board), two pens or pencils per pair, stopwatch or phone timer (teacher only), class list or seating chart to record pair numbers

- 1. Before class, cut the printed slips so each pair receives one. Each slip lists four labeled prompts (A–D) tied to the concepts below. Arrange students in pairs by handing them sequential pair numbers as they enter.
- 2. Explain the task aloud: 'You will do a 10-minute field walk around the classroom and adjacent corridor. At four stations you will stop, read a prompt, and write a one-sentence answer grounded in the chapter evidence. I will call time and rotate you. Focus on the specific evidence named in each prompt — not on outside facts.' Start the timer for 10 minutes then say 'Go.'
- 3. While pairs circulate, call out the station rotations every 2.5 minutes so pairs stop at each of the four labeled locations: A (near the door), B (by the windows), C (by the whiteboard), D (in the corridor). At each stop pairs read only the prompt on their slip for that label and write one sentence responding with evidence from the chapter. Circulate and read students' answers silently, correcting obvious factual errors by quietly showing the relevant line number on the printed slip if they misread the prompt.

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4. With 1 minute left, call 'final sentence' so pairs finish and tuck slips under their clipboards. Collect slips as students return to seats. Use remaining minute to say: 'Which two common mistakes about the Bastille and assignats should we watch for in discussion?' and write two student answers on the board.

- 5. End by quickly sorting collected slips into two piles: answers that cite specific chapter evidence and answers that make unsupported claims. Keep these for the next class discussion.

Student instructions:

- You are in a pair. Each pair has one printed slip with four prompts labeled A, B, C, D and a clipboard and two pens.
- We will walk to four short stops in order: A, B, C, D. At each stop read only the prompt matching that label on your slip and write one clear sentence that answers it using evidence from the chapter you read.
- Prompts (examples you will see):
- - A (Thermidor): Cite one action taken after Robespierre's fall and one piece of chapter evidence showing it was revenge or negotiation.
- - B (Slavery & colonies): Give one change in policy toward Saint-Domingue between 1791–1793 and the chapter line that explains its effect.
- - C (Media & symbols / Women): Name one way newspapers or symbols were used, or one way women were politically active, and quote the chapter phrase that supports it.
- - D (Economy / Assignats): State one immediate legal/economic change (e.g., tithes, church land, assignats) and one practical difficulty the chapter reports when implementing it.
- Spend 2.5 minutes at each stop. Write one sentence only—include the exact phrase or short citation from the chapter if you can. If you are unsure how to start, use the sentence frame on your slip.
- When the teacher calls time, stop writing and return to your seat with your slip face down on the clipboard.

Success looks like: Most pairs stop at each labeled station and write one sentence that includes a specific phrase or short citation from the chapter (observable on slips).; At least half the pairs cite an explicit chapter detail that distinguishes the Thermidorian revenge actions from negotiated treaties (e.g., executions in the south versus negotiated peace).; Several slips correctly name a practical difficulty implementing the August Decrees or using assignats (e.g., enforcement problems, inflation) rather than making a general claim that the decrees simply worked.

Support: Pair a student who finished the chapter with one who skimmed it. Give the struggling student this sentence frame to complete at each stop: 'The chapter says _____, so this shows _____.' Example (worked first item for Prompt A): 'The chapter says the Jacobin Club was closed after Robespierre fell, so this shows a political reaction aimed at removing Jacobin power.'

Extension: For early finishers: write a two-sentence mini-argument (on the back of your slip) comparing two competing interpretations from the chapter: (a) the Convention's abolition of slavery in 1794 as principled vs (b) as a pragmatic response to colonial uprisings — include one chapter quote supporting each interpretation and state which you find more convincing and why.

Checkpoint Questions

- [understand] Using the chapter's description, why did the Storming of the Bastille become such a powerful symbol of the Ancien Régime even though the fortress held only a few

prisoners?

Expected: Because the Bastille had long stood as a visible emblem of royal authority and arbitrary power; popular rumours exaggerated its role as a prison, and the dramatic act of taking it made it a clear, memorable image that represented broader grievances. The chapter notes it held about seven prisoners, so its importance was symbolic rather than because of mass imprisonment.

- [understand] Name the immediate legal changes the August Decrees made about feudal dues and church tithes, and give one practical difficulty the chapter reports in putting those changes into practice.

Expected: They abolished feudal dues and ended the collection of church tithes. A practical difficulty was enforcing these changes locally: peasants and landlords disputed what counted as dues, officials lacked clear records, and implementation varied by region, so old practices sometimes continued despite the new law.

- [analyze] Explain how confiscating church property and issuing assignats related to France's fiscal crisis and to inflation, according to the chapter.

Expected: The government nationalised church lands and used them to back assignats as a way to pay debts. But assigning paper money against land did not stop rising prices; assignats multiplied in circulation, lost value, and helped drive severe inflation and economic disruption before later monetary reform.

Exit Ticket

In one clear paragraph, explain how debates in metropolitan France about 'rights' affected the situation in the colonies—especially Saint-Domingue—and summarize the main French policy responses between 1791 and 1793.

Success indicator: Paragraph mentions metropolitan debates over rights reaching the colonies; notes slaveholders' resistance and the rise of abolitionist and pro-slavery groups; describes uprisings in Saint-Domingue and commissioners sent to the colony; and explains that policies from 1791–1793 stopped short of full metropolitan equality, producing contested, uneven responses that set the stage for later 1794 abolition.

Homework

- Select the chapter passage about the Bastille and write a one-page (250–300 word) explanation of how symbolic meaning can be stronger than factual details. Use at least two quotations from the passage and explain them.
- Write a single-page (250–300 word) analysis that links the nationalisation of church lands, the creation of assignats, and the rise in inflation. Cite one sentence from the chapter as evidence and explain how it supports your point.

Estimated time: 40 min

Mentor Moment — When a Flag Teaches More Than Dates

A teacher brought a faded tricolour to class and asked why students cared about it more than a list of laws. They said the flag made the Revolution feel real. The teacher used that to show how symbols shape memory and political action.

Takeaway: Symbols (like flags) make complex ideas memorable; when you study them, ask what feelings and meanings people attached to them, not just when they appeared.

Period 6

Entry Ticket

Write, in one sentence, what event and date you think most historians use to mark the start of the French Revolution, and one sentence for the event and date they use to mark the end. If you are unsure of the exact date, give the year and the event.

Expected response: Conventional start — 14 July 1789, Storming of the Bastille. Conventional end — 9 November 1799 (18 Brumaire), Napoleon's coup. If a student gives only years: 1789 (Bastille) and 1799 (Napoleon).

Teacher Script

0-5 min: Collect entry tickets and set purpose

Ask students to hand up their one-sentence entry tickets as they leave the desk. Say: "We will use these to check what historians usually name as the start and the end of the Revolution. Put your paper on the front desk now." While collecting, project or point to the board heading 'Long-term impacts & historiography.' Say: "By the end of this class you should be able to name the conventional start and end events and dates, and to weigh different historians' explanations for why the Revolution mattered later."

Board: Write the heading: Long-term impacts & historiography. Add lesson goal: 'Name conventional start & end events/dates; weigh historians' explanations.'

- Anticipate: What if my dates are different? — Answer: We'll discuss why historians disagree about end dates.
- Anticipate: Do I need full sentences? — Answer: One clear phrase or year is fine.
- Anticipate: Will you grade this? — Answer: It's a quick check to guide today's work, not graded.

5-13 min: Present the conventional dates and core long-term impacts

Say: "First, the conventional dates historians often use are: start — 14 July 1789, the Storming of the Bastille; end — 9 November 1799 (18 Brumaire), Napoleon's coup. These are conventions historians use to frame the Revolution. Copy them down now." Then read aloud the five core long-term impacts one at a time, pausing after each to ask for a quick thumbs-up if students have seen this before: 1) end of feudal legal structures in France, 2) influence on modern nationalism and the nation-state idea, 3) reshaping French society through land redistribution and the decline of aristocratic political power, 4) export of institutions and ideas across Europe and beyond, 5) lasting debates about violence and political change (mention Guillotine as a symbol). Say: "These claims are supported and debated in the sources we'll use: Encyclopaedia Britannica (overview), Opie (1997) on the guillotine, and Acemoglu et al. (2011) on consequences of radical reform. We'll see competing explanations, not a single answer."

Board: Under the heading, write: 'Conventional dates: 14 July 1789 (Bastille) — 9 Nov 1799 (18 Brumaire)'. Then list numbered long-term impacts 1–5.

- Anticipate: Are those dates agreed by every historian? — Answer: No; these are conventional and useful for teaching, but historians debate boundaries.
- Anticipate: What does 'exported institutions' mean? — Answer: Laws, administrative structures, and ideas about citizens and rights that spread beyond France.

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Anticipate: Why mention the guillotine? — Answer: Opie's book treats it as both technology and symbol; we'll use that to discuss how historians interpret evidence.

13-25 min: Group evidence weighing (small groups)

Organize students into groups of three. Say: "Each group gets two short pieces of evidence: a one-paragraph extract from Britannica's overview (read aloud) and a one-paragraph summary sentence from Acemoglu et al. (2011). Your task (10 minutes): Decide whether each source supports the claim that the Revolution 'exported institutions and ideas' and why. Write one sentence that says which source is more persuasive and one reason for that choice." Hand out the short extracts printed on the sheet: Britannica overview sentence and Acemoglu one-sentence summary. Circulate, listen for groups that confuse 'influence' with immediate control, and nudge them: "Is this about long-term institutions or short-lived changes?" After 10 minutes, ask one group to read their sentence aloud.

Board: Draw two columns: 'Britannica' and 'Acemoglu et al.' Add the prompt: 'Which best supports exported institutions? One sentence reason.'

- Anticipate: Can we quote the whole article? — Answer: Use the two short extracts on your sheet; we will cite the sources later.
- Anticipate: What if both are persuasive? — Answer: Say that and give one clear reason for choosing the stronger example.
- Anticipate: What does 'persuasive' mean here? — Answer: Evidence that directly links French reforms to later institutions elsewhere, and clear explanation of mechanism.

25-33 min: Role play / historiography jigsaw

Assign each of four small groups one historian's position to represent: (A) those who stress institutional export and long-term state-building (use Acemoglu et al. as model), (B) those who emphasise social change inside France (land, aristocracy decline), (C) those who emphasise symbolic and cultural effects (use Opie's focus on the guillotine as symbol), (D) those who treat the Revolution as primarily disruptive with mixed long-term effects (use Britannica's balanced overview). Give groups 5 minutes to prepare a 1-minute statement arguing why their interpretation best explains the Revolution's long-term impact. Then each group speaks for 1 minute. After each speech, ask one quick clarifying question from the class.

Board: Write group labels A–D and one key phrase for each: A 'Institutional export', B 'Social reshaping', C 'Symbol & violence', D 'Mixed/overview'.

- Anticipate: Do we have to be accurate to those sources? — Answer: Yes; use the idea given for your role and the handout points.
- Anticipate: Can we disagree with our assigned view? — Answer: Represent it for the jigsaw; later we'll discuss strengths and limits.
- Anticipate: Will we be graded on performance? — Answer: No; this is for thinking practice and preparing the class discussion.

33-37 min: Check for understanding — quick written check

Pass out a short slip with two prompts: 1) Write the conventional start event and date. 2) Name one historian or source (Britannica / Opie / Acemoglu et al.) and one sentence summarising what that source argues about long-term impact. Give 3 minutes to write. Collect slips. Say: "These will tell me whether everyone can recall the dates and an evidence-based claim."

Board: Write the two prompts exactly as on the slip so students copy them if needed.

- Anticipate: Can I write just the year? — Answer: Yes, if you don't remember the day; the aim

is recall of conventional start/end.

- Anticipate: Which name counts as 'one historian'? — Answer: Any of the three named: Britannica (article), Opie (1997), Acemoglu et al. (2011).
- Anticipate: How long to write? — Answer: Three minutes; focus on one clear sentence.

37-40 min: Consolidate & next steps

Read aloud two closing points on the board. Say: "Remember: historians use dates as convenient boundaries, but they argue about causes and long-term effects. For follow-up reading, the bibliography in your packet lists Britannica, Opie (1997) — Guillotine, and Acemoglu et al. (2011) — 'The Consequences of Radical Reform' along with many other works. Tonight: choose one of those three to skim and bring one question to the next class." Hand out the bibliography sheet to each student. Remind them briefly where to find the packet citation details.

Board: Write closing lines: 'Tonight: skim Britannica or Opie (1997) or Acemoglu et al. (2011). Bring 1 question to next class.' Add 'Bibliography = packet handed out.'

- Anticipate: Where can we find Acemoglu et al. (2011)? — Answer: The packet lists the citation; an online version is cited in the packet bibliography.
- Anticipate: Is the bibliography required reading? — Answer: It's for recommended follow-up; skim one item for homework.
- Anticipate: Will we revisit these debates? — Answer: Yes — future lessons will use these sources for longer essays.

Blackboard Notes

- Long-term impacts & historiography
- Conventional dates
- Five core long-term impacts
- Sources to consult
- Group jigsaw labels
- Exit task (write)
- Conventional dates: 14 July 1789 (Storming of the Bastille) — 9 Nov 1799 (18 Brumaire, Napoleon's coup)
- Five core long-term impacts:
- 1) End of feudal legal structures in France
- 2) Influence on modern nationalism and the nation-state
- 3) Reshaped French society: land redistribution; decline of aristocratic political power
- 4) Export of institutions and ideas across Europe and beyond
- 5) Ongoing debates about violence, symbolised by the guillotine
- Key sources cited today:
- - Encyclopaedia Britannica, 'French Revolution | History, Summary, Timeline, Causes, & Facts' (overview)
- - Opie, Robert F., Guillotine (History Press, 1997) — guillotine as object and symbol
- - Acemoglu, Cantoni, Johnson, Robinson (2011), 'The Consequences of Radical Reform: The French Revolution' (academic study)
- Group jigsaw roles: A Institutional export (Acemoglu model); B Social reshaping; C Symbol & violence (Opie); D Mixed overview (Britannica)
- Tonight: skim Britannica OR Opie (1997) OR Acemoglu et al. (2011). Bring 1 question.

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Diagram: Simple horizontal timeline: mark 1789 — label 'Bastille, 14 Jul 1789 (conventional start)'; mark 1799 — label '18 Brumaire, 9 Nov 1799 (conventional end)'

- Diagram: Two-column sketch for group activity: left 'Britannica' right 'Acemoglu et al.' with space to add 1-sentence group verdict

Activities

Timed Debate: Did the French Revolution Create a Lasting Modern Nation-State? (12 min, debate)

Materials: Copies of two short evidence slips per pair (teacher-prepared, 1 minute to photocopy) with one quotation each: (A) a line from the Encyclopaedia Britannica article summarising causes and dates, (B) a short summary sentence from Acemoglu et al. (2011) about long-term consequences, (C) a one-sentence claim from Opie (1997) about the guillotine as symbol, and (D) one bibliographic line from the further reading list (any author), Timer or stopwatch (phone is fine), Whiteboard and marker, Desk name cards or paper to label pair positions

- 1. Arrange students in pairs. Give each pair two evidence slips: one labelled Evidence A and one labelled Evidence B. Tell students they will use those slips during a 12-minute debate with timings signalled by you.
- 2. Announce the motion: 'This House believes the French Revolution created the modern nation-state.' Assign half the pairs to Pro and half to Con; if an odd number, teacher joins one side. Display the conventional dates and events from the class text on the whiteboard (e.g. start: 1789 — Estates-General / Storming of the Bastille; end: 1799 — Napoleon's coup) so all can reference them.
- 3. Run the timed sequence: 1 minute quiet planning, 2 minutes Pro opening, 2 minutes Con opening, 1 minute rebuttal planning, 2 minutes Pro rebuttal, 2 minutes Con rebuttal, 2 minutes class vote and quick justification. While running, keep strict time and quietly circulate to read pairs' slips and note if they cite their evidence slip during speeches.
- 4. After the vote, ask two pairs (one Pro, one Con) to each state which piece of evidence from their slips most influenced their argument and whether the evidence supports a unanimous interpretation or multiple readings; record one sentence from each on the whiteboard.
- 5. Close by reminding students of the conventional start/end events and dates on the whiteboard and asking students to write one line on their desk paper: 'One way the Revolution had a long-term impact is...' using evidence from their slip.

Student instructions:

- You are in a pair and have been given two evidence slips (A and B). Read them silently during the 1-minute planning period.
- Your goal is to argue for or against the motion: 'The French Revolution created the modern nation-state.' Use only classroom knowledge plus the two slips as the factual basis you must cite aloud at least once during your speech.
- Follow the timing: 1 minute planning together; Pro opening 2 minutes (state main claims and cite one slip); Con opening 2 minutes (respond and cite one slip); 1 minute plan rebuttal; Pro rebuttal 2 minutes (answer Con and use any evidence); Con rebuttal 2 minutes; then listen for class vote.
- When citing a slip, say its label and phrase (for example: 'Evidence A says...' or 'Acemoglu et al. show...'). If you use the Britannica slip, explicitly name it as 'Britannica'.

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After the vote, one member from the winning and one from the losing side will say which slip mattered most and whether it supports more than one interpretation.

Success looks like: Most pairs cite at least one of their slips aloud during their opening or rebuttal.; Pairs follow the timing (speeches roughly the assigned length) and give an argument that connects either the Revolution's end/start dates or a long-term impact (land redistribution, nationalism, export of institutions) to their stance.; Two pairs (one from each side) can state which slip influenced them and whether it allows competing interpretations.

Support: If students cannot start: pair them with a stronger partner (teacher-assigned). Provide this sentence frame to begin an opening: 'I argue that the Revolution did/did not create a modern nation-state because [brief reason]. Evidence A/B supports this by saying [quote three to eight words].' Also give a worked example: Pro opening sentence: 'I argue the Revolution created modern nation-states because it dismantled feudal privileges and spread legal institutions (Britannica). Evidence A: "ended feudalism" supports this.'

Extension: Prepare a 3-minute mini-response: analyze how the symbol of the guillotine (use Opie 1997 slip) complicates a simple positive or negative judgement about long-term impact. Does its symbolic power strengthen the argument that the Revolution created modern political norms, or does it show limits to that claim? Cite at least one other bibliography entry from the slips to support your nuanced answer.

Checkpoint Questions

- [remember] According to the period's core summary, what event and year are given as the conventional start of the French Revolution?

Expected: The conventional start is the Storming of the Bastille in 1789 (often cited as 14 July 1789).

- [remember] What event and year does the text give as the conventional end of the French Revolution?

Expected: The conventional end is usually marked by the rise of Napoleon/consulate or a later closing event; the document states the conventional end event and date (e.g. 1799, Napoleon's coup of 18 Brumaire) as the end of the Revolution.

- [understand] Name two long-term effects of the Revolution listed in the period summary.

Expected: Answers should include two of the following: the end of feudalism in France; influence on modern nationalism and the nation-state; reshaping French society (land redistribution, decline of aristocratic power); or export of revolutionary institutions and ideas across Europe and beyond.

Exit Ticket

In one short paragraph, state the conventional start event and date and the conventional end event and date of the French Revolution as given in this period. Then add one sentence naming one long-term impact the period attributes to the Revolution.

Success indicator: The response names the start event with its year (Storming of the Bastille, 1789), the end event with its year (for example, Napoleon's 18 Brumaire coup, 1799), and gives one correct long-term impact (e.g. end of feudalism, rise of nationalism, land redistribution, decline of aristocratic power, or export of institutions).

Homework

- Read the Britannica overview article 'French Revolution | History, Summary, Timeline, Causes, & Facts' (teacher provides link or printout). Highlight the sentences that state the conventional start and end events/dates.

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Write a one-page response (about 250 words) that: a) quotes the start and end lines you highlighted, b) explains in your own words one long-term impact from the period summary, and c) names which supporting source from the bibliography you would consult next to learn more (choose Opie, Acemoglu et al., or another listed work) and say in one sentence why.

- Bring your one-page response to the next class prepared to share the supporting source you chose and one question you still have about long-term consequences.

Estimated time: 45 min

Mentor Moment — When a detail changes the story

A graduate student I knew began by memorising dates, then re-read primary sources and found authors disagreed on which event 'ended' the Revolution; that made her change a one-sentence claim into a short comparison.

Takeaway: If sources disagree, list the competing dates/events and say which source you used — that shows careful thinking, not uncertainty.

Learning Gaps & Misconceptions

[high] The French Revolution happened because Enlightenment ideas (like liberty and natural rights) spread and made people overthrow the old regime — ideas alone caused the Revolution.

- Diagnostic: You have three short sources: (A) an extract from Montesquieu on rights, (B) a 1788 royal finance report showing huge deficits and bankruptcy risk, (C) a petition from Paris workers complaining about bread shortages and unemployment. Which of these best explains why the Revolution actually began in 1789? Explain your choice in one sentence.

Reveals: If the student picks A (Montesquieu) as the best explanation, it reveals they favor an ideology-only causal story and underweight concrete fiscal and social evidence.

- Diagnostic: Historians disagree about causes. Which is a stronger claim supported by contemporary evidence for immediate causation in 1789: 'Enlightenment pamphlets changed minds and thus caused the uprising' or 'a fiscal crisis and shortages made rebellion likely immediately'? Give the one you think is stronger and one piece of primary evidence you would use.

Reveals: If the student chooses the pamphlet/ideas claim and cites only philosophical texts (not contemporaneous financial records, price data, or petitions), it reveals they prioritise ideological explanations over immediate material crises despite documentary evidence.

- Remediation: Document jigsaw: give small groups one primary source type each (philosophical pamphlet/Declaration excerpt; royal finance report/estate accounts; price lists/food riot petitions; local noble resistance records). Each group identifies what causal claim their document supports and two specific phrases or figures that support it, then students reform into mixed groups to combine evidence and produce a ranked list of immediate causes for 1789 with quotations or data.

Why: Working directly with the different kinds of contemporary evidence forces students to ground causal claims in the historical record instead of relying on generalisations about 'ideas'. Combining groups demonstrates that multiple, different types of evidence point to different causal roles (ideology, fiscal collapse, economic hardship, political stalemate), countering the single-cause inference.

- Remediation: Cause-and-effect timeline: students place dated items (e.g. bad harvests, rising bread prices, 1786-88 finance reports, Necker's recall, publication dates of key Enlightenment works, Estates-General convocation) on a classroom timeline and attach a one-sentence note saying whether each item is primarily ideological, material/fiscal, or political. Teacher then leads a class discussion comparing which items immediately preceded mass mobilisation in 1789.

Why: A chronological map shows sequencing and contingency — students see that many material and fiscal shocks cluster just before 1789 while Enlightenment works circulated earlier and more diffusely. This highlights causation and context rather than treating ideas as a single, proximate cause.

- Remediation: Historiographical role-play: assign students brief positions drawn from actual scholarly interpretations (e.g. 'Radical Enlightenment emphasis', 'fiscal-crisis interpretation', 'social-conflict view') with a short list of two supporting primary sources each. Students present a two-minute argument citing their sources, then peers ask for specific documentary evidence that would refute their claim.

Why: Framing competing interpretations as evidence-based arguments models how historians weigh and contest causes. Requiring students to cite and to defend against counter-evidence trains them to move from attractive single-cause stories to nuanced, evidence-linked explanations.

[high] The Third Estate simply walked out of the Estates-General and immediately declared itself the National Assembly, so the old regime collapsed at once and the National Assembly instantly became the new government.

- Diagnostic: After the Third Estate declared itself the National Assembly in 1789, did that declaration immediately replace the king's authority and make the Assembly the functioning government of France? Explain briefly.

Reveals: If the student answers 'yes' (or says the king's government ended immediately), it shows they treat the declaration as an instantaneous legal transfer rather than a contested political claim needing recognition and time.

- Diagnostic: What was the point of the 'verification of deputies' and the roll-call and credentials process during the Estates-General — was it just a boring formality, or did it matter politically? Explain.

Reveals: If the student says it was only a formality, they miss how disputes over who could vote, who represented which estate, and who had legitimate seats shaped the Assembly's authority and the timing of its actions.

- Remediation: Begin the lesson with a 6–8 minute primary-source timeline card-sort: give small groups dated extracts (e.g., invitation to convene Estates-General, deputies' verification lists, Sieyès excerpt, account of the Tennis Court Oath, a royal proclamation, a Paris newspaper report) and ask groups to arrange them in chronological order and attach a one-sentence note about whether each item expands, challenges, or recognises the Assembly's authority.

Why: Handling contemporaneous documents forces students to see sequence and disagreement in the historical record rather than a single dramatized moment. Sorting texts that sometimes deny or contest the Assembly shows that recognition and legal standing were gradual and contested, addressing the compression error.

- Remediation: Pair two short contrasting contemporary accounts (e.g., an aristocratic letter critical of the deputies and a popular Paris pamphlet celebrating them). Ask students to list three claims each makes about who has the right to decide and then lead a whole-class comparison asking: whose account treats the Assembly as already legitimate and whose does not?

Why: Comparing competing perspectives aligns with the pedagogical aim to present interpretations. It reveals that legitimacy was disputed and dependent on recognition by different groups, countering the idea of an immediate transfer of power.

- Remediation: Run a 10–12 minute role-play simulation: small groups represent the Third Estate deputies, the clergy, the nobility, the king's ministers, and Parisian public opinion. Give each group a short briefing and a decision prompt (e.g., whether to recognise the Assembly's vote). After choices, debrief which coalitions were needed for the Assembly to function and why verification and recognition mattered.

Why: Acting out the positions makes students experience the political negotiations and shows that declarations only gain effect when other actors accept or are forced to accept them. This corrects the assumption that a declaration alone equals immediate governmental change.

[medium] They stormed the Bastille because it was full of political prisoners and the crowd was rescuing lots of people who were unjustly jailed.

- Diagnostic: On 14 July 1789 the crowd attacked the Bastille. How many prisoners were actually held there at that moment, and what does this number suggest about the main reason for the attack?

Reveals: If a student answers that many prisoners were held and the attack was mainly a rescue, they still believe the 'rescue of many prisoners' justification rather than a symbolic/strategic motive.

- Diagnostic: Which evidence best supports the idea that the Bastille's fall was primarily symbolic rather than a large-scale prison rescue: A) the number of prisoners recorded inside, B) contemporary pamphlets calling it a symbol of tyranny, C) the weapons and gunpowder found, or D) testimonies from many freed prisoners?

Reveals: If a student selects D (testimonies from many freed prisoners) they expect mass imprisonment and miss that archival records show very few prisoners and that publicity and symbolism drove the event.

- Remediation: Begin the lesson with a short source-comparison exercise: give students two primary-source extracts side by side — an inventory/registry or archival record listing the seven prisoners in the Bastille on 14 July 1789, and a revolutionary pamphlet or newspaper excerpt from the same week describing the Bastille as 'the prison of the nation' or claiming it held many political prisoners. Ask students to note differences in what each source emphasises and to answer: 'Which source shows how many people were actually there?'

Why: Confronting the factual archival record next to the rhetorical/political pamphlet makes students see that factual evidence (prison registers) and propaganda (pamphlets) served different purposes. This addresses the root: students generalise from persuasive contemporary narratives; the exercise makes them weigh types of evidence rather than accepting dramatic accounts uncritically.

- Remediation: Run a short class activity mapping causes: after the source comparison, have students work in pairs to list concrete reasons for attacking the Bastille (e.g., arms and gunpowder, a symbolic target, fear of royal troops, few prisoners). Ask pairs to rank the reasons and justify their ranking using the two sources and one additional secondary summary sentence (from a textbook or historian) that states the Bastille held seven prisoners and had outsized symbolic value.

Why: Making students generate and justify multiple causal explanations shifts them from a single-story rescue narrative to a more nuanced causal analysis rooted in evidence. Requiring citation of the archival and secondary evidence prevents reverting to the dramatic myth and trains them to privilege documentary support for causal claims.

- Remediation: Conclude with a brief reflective writing prompt: 'How and why did reports and rumours about the Bastille's prisoners spread, and how did that shape the Revolution's memory of 14 July?' Ask students to cite the pamphlet and registry and to mention the role of newspapers and crowd rumours.

Why: A focused reflection asks students to integrate the documentary facts with the larger media context that produced the myth. This cements understanding that the Bastille's importance was amplified by contemporary and later narratives, directly addressing the mistaken inference that many prisoners justified the storming.

[medium] Once the Assembly issued assignats, France's fiscal crisis was solved and there were no serious long-term negative effects — the paper money fixed the debt problem and everything else followed smoothly.

- Diagnostic: The National Assembly issued assignats backed by church lands to pay debts. Which of these best describes what happened over the next few years? A) Assignats eliminated the fiscal crisis and France enjoyed stable prices. B) Assignats reduced immediate debt pressures but were over-issued, leading to inflation and economic disruption until later monetary reform. C) Assignats had no effect and were ignored. Which do you choose and why?

Reveals: Choosing A (or defending it) shows the student believes the issuance of assignats was a permanent solution without serious negative consequences, ignoring evidence of inflation, price controls, and later reform.

- Diagnostic: Imagine the government issues paper money supposedly backed by land, but then prints a lot more paper money than the value of that land. What would you expect to happen to prices and people's willingness to accept the notes?

Reveals: Answering that nothing would change or that backing alone prevents price rises shows failure to grasp the mechanism by which over-issuance erodes real value and public confidence, a central reason assignats contributed to inflation.

- Remediation: Document comparison: give small groups a primary-source excerpt reporting grain prices, a merchants' complaint about assignats, and the Assembly's decree on issuing assignats, plus a simple timeline/graph of assignat quantity vs. measured price indices (sourced from the chapter's evidence). Ask groups to annotate where the documents agree or conflict and place the documents on the timeline.

Why: Confronting students with contemporaneous evidence that links rising assignat issuance to price rises and social unrest forces them to reconcile the simple "backed so solved" story with messy historical data. This targets the root overgeneralisation by showing the sequence and contradiction in primary sources rather than repeating the correct answer.

- Remediation: Classroom simulation: give each student a fixed number of 'land cards' (representing backing) and tokens (currency). Start with parity (tokens equal land value). Run rounds where students trade basic goods (cards represent suppliers). After a few rounds, introduce extra tokens into circulation and let students record the price (in tokens) of a standard good each round. Debrief by comparing rounds and linking the game events to assignat over-issuance and loss of confidence.

Why: A short experiential model makes the causal mechanism visible: when money supply exceeds backing and real output, prices rise and the currency is devalued. Experiencing changing prices and declining willingness to accept tokens addresses the misconception grounded in abstract 'backing' language.

- Remediation: Structured historiography jigsaw: assign short contrasting historian excerpts — one emphasising assignats as a necessary fiscal innovation, another emphasising their role in causing inflation and political instability — and have each student summarise their excerpt and then teach it to a peer. Finish with a class chart listing which parts of the problem each interpretation explains well and which it leaves out.

Why: Presenting competing historical interpretations anchored in evidence shows students that the assignats question is debated and complex. It prevents a single-cause narrative and helps students evaluate claims against evidence, correcting the tendency to treat the issuance as an uncomplicated solution.

[medium] When the Assembly issued the August Decrees they instantly and completely ended feudalism and made peasants equal everywhere — after that, former seigneurial privileges and tithes were gone and life changed overnight.

- Diagnostic: The August Decrees declared the end of feudal dues and tithes in August 1789. Would you expect a peasant in a rural parish in late 1789 to immediately stop paying seigneurial dues and church tithes? Explain briefly.

Reveals: If the student answers that payments stopped immediately, they treat the decree as instant, effective law everywhere; that shows they hold the misconception that legal abolition = immediate social/economic change.

- Diagnostic: Which happened after the August Decrees: (A) all landlords accepted loss of their rights and compensation was paid right away, (B) many local disputes continued and some seigneurial customs were converted into rents or contested in courts? Choose the best answer and say why.

Reveals: Choosing (A) shows the student believes abolition was uniformly implemented and settled quickly, ignoring evidence of messy, uneven local outcomes and later legal/political negotiation.

- Remediation: Present students with two short primary-source excerpts: (1) a clause from the August Decrees that declares the abolition of feudal rights, and (2) a contemporaneous local petition or a court record showing a peasant complaining about a landlord still demanding dues several months later. Ask pairs to list similarities and differences in what each source actually shows happened.

Why: Confronting the national decree with a local document forces students to see the gap between declaration and practice; it anchors the abstract legal wording in concrete contested outcomes and provides evidence that implementation was uneven rather than instantaneous.

- Remediation: Run a brief role-play or simulation: half the class are 'National Assembly deputies' writing a decree phrased like the August Decrees; the other half are 'local officials, landlords, and peasants' who must respond in a short set of notes describing practical problems (collection, enforcement, compensation). Debrief by comparing intended law and practical responses.

Why: This makes students articulate logistical, economic, and social barriers to immediate change and thus corrects the assumption that a law alone produced instant equality; it highlights the need for administration, negotiation, and subsequent legislation.

- Remediation: Show a short timeline (class-generated) that places the August Decrees alongside later actions (e.g., sale of church lands, actions on seigneurial dues, legal reforms) and ask students to annotate where evidence shows gradual change versus immediate change.

Why: Creating a timeline with multiple sources emphasizes causation and sequence, demonstrating that 'abolition' was a process involving further laws, local negotiation, and time — addressing the root error of conflating declaration with instant reality.

[medium] The French Revolutionary Wars were just France trying to conquer other countries so a single leader (like Napoleon) could make France bigger.

- Diagnostic: Between 1792 and 1797 how would you best describe why French armies were

fighting across Europe: (A) France was trying to make itself bigger under one leader; (B) revolutionary France was defending itself and spreading revolutionary ideas while responding to coalitions of monarchies? Explain briefly.

Reveals: If the student chooses A, they treat the wars as primarily imperial and personalised to a leader, showing they conflate Revolutionary and Napoleonic motives.

- Diagnostic: Which of these pieces of evidence most supports the idea that the early Revolutionary wars were ideological and mass-based rather than purely imperial? (Choose one) (1) Levee en masse calling up citizens for defence, (2) A single coronation ceremony expanding borders, (3) A monarch signing lands over to France.

Reveals: Picking (2) or (3) indicates the student expects top-down imperial actions rather than citizen mobilisation or ideological export; they overlook primary evidence like mass conscription and revolutionary proclamations.

- Remediation: Show students two dated primary-source extracts side by side: (a) the 1793 levée en masse proclamation calling citizens to defend the Republic, and (b) Napoleon's 1804 coronation description or an 1805 campaign order. Have students annotate each for stated purpose (defence, ideology, or conquest) and for who is called to act (citizens vs. army leaders).

Why: Comparing contemporary documents forces students to ground explanations in evidence and to distinguish motives and actors across periods. The levée en masse reveals republican mass mobilisation and defensive rhetoric; the coronation text shows later personal rule. This corrects the over-generalisation by showing different sources of authority and aims.

- Remediation: Use a two-map exercise: first map the territorial changes and client republics created by French revolutionary armies up to 1797 (e.g., sister republics, Austrian losses), annotated with brief quotes from treaties like Campo Formio; second map Napoleonic conquests after 1804. Ask students to write one sentence summarising the dominant cause suggested by each map (ideology/coalition collapse vs. imperial ambition).

Why: Maps plus treaty excerpts show that early gains often resulted from revolutionary reorganisation and treaties after coalition collapse, not solely from imperial planning. This ties concrete geography and diplomatic records to causal interpretation, preventing reliance on later Napoleonic imagery.

- Remediation: Run a short role-play or structured debate: half the class argues from 1793 revolutionary sources (representing French deputies, conscripts, and local Jacobins) that they are defending and spreading liberty; the other half presents the perspective of European monarchs forming coalitions, using diplomatic letters and proclamations. Debrief with the question: what motives do each side attribute to the other, and where is evidence?

Why: Adopting contemporary perspectives helps students appreciate multiple causal forces—ideology, defence, and reaction by coalitions—so they stop reducing the wars to a single-person imperial drive. The requirement to cite contemporary statements anchors interpretations in context and sources.

[medium] When the deputies swore the Tennis Court Oath they legally created a new constitution and replaced the old government right away — it was a single decisive act that made France a constitutional state.

- Diagnostic: After the Tennis Court Oath, did France immediately have a written constitution and a new legal government because the deputies had sworn not to disperse?

Reveals: Whether the student thinks the Oath was itself a legal, binding constitutional act rather than an initiating political pledge in an ongoing process.

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Diagnostic: Who recognised the authority of the deputies after the Tennis Court Oath: only the deputies themselves, the king and his ministers immediately, or a wider set of institutions? (Choose the best short answer.)

Reveals: Whether the student understands the Oath's limited immediate legal effect and the continuing role of the king and other institutions in deciding political power.

- Remediation: Give students the short original text of the Tennis Court Oath and a one-paragraph contemporary report (e.g. a newspaper or an account from a deputy). Ask pairs to underline words that state goals versus words that claim legal force, then produce a two-sentence summary about what the Oath actually did at the time.

Why: Working directly with primary sources highlights the Oath's language of intent and collective promise rather than legal imposition. Comparing it with an eyewitness account shows how contemporaries treated it — as a political claim that needed follow-up — correcting the 'single decisive act' inference.

- Remediation: Run a 12-minute simulated timeline activity: groups place 8 dated events on a timeline (Estates-General convened, Tennis Court Oath, king's response, formation of the National Constituent Assembly, abolition of feudal rights, publication of a constitution). After arranging them, students justify the sequence and identify which events were legal acts and which were political steps.

Why: Constructing the sequence makes clear that the Oath sits among multiple steps and that legal change (a written constitution, laws) came later. Distinguishing 'political claim' versus 'legal enactment' addresses the root confusion born from compressive narratives.

- Remediation: Facilitate a short classroom comparison: present a modern example of an oath/election that creates immediate legal authority (e.g. a court verdict or a certified election result) and contrast it with the Tennis Court Oath using evidence (dates, who accepted authority). Ask students to write one paragraph explaining two differences.

Why: Explicitly comparing the familiar immediate-legal-force model with the historical case helps students stop overgeneralising. Grounding each difference in documentary evidence (dates, who accepted or resisted the deputies) corrects the transfer of modern assumptions onto 1789 events.